Activity 03 - Conflict Style Choice Clinic at BrightWorks Digital

Course: Mastering The Art of Conflict Resolution to Foster Team Collaboration and Success (TGS-2023021752) Duration: 45 minutes Materials: Style decision matrix Output: A conflict-style decision matrix and staged response for the BrightWorks security-versus-launch dispute.

Objective

Select and justify a conflict style based on stakes, urgency, relationship and power.

Psychological-safety boundary

Use only the fictional case. Do not require anyone to disclose a personal conflict. Any participant may call a pause or request another role. This learning activity does not replace organisational policy, HR advice or legal advice.

Scenario

BrightWorks Digital's product and sales teams disagree about releasing a feature before security testing is complete. Sales promises a launch date to a key client; Product says the unresolved issue may expose customer data. The CEO wants a decision today, but both teams must work together for the next six months. Learners assess five possible styles and explain a staged response rather than declaring one style universally best.

Detailed instructions

1. Frame the issue. State the decision in one neutral sentence and list the shared interests of client trust, product value, security and continued collaboration.

2. Rate five conditions. For safety, outcome importance, relationship importance, power/voice and time pressure, choose low, medium or high and cite case evidence.

3. Review each style. For compete, collaborate, compromise, avoid and accommodate, write one potential benefit and one risk in this case.

4. Identify non-negotiables. Name any legal, ethical, safety, security or policy threshold that cannot be traded for speed or harmony.

5. Choose the immediate style. Select the approach for today's deadline. Explain who has authority and how dissenting expertise will still be heard.

6. Choose the follow-on style. Select a different or continuing approach for the next two weeks so the immediate decision does not become the entire resolution.

7. Protect voice. Add a mechanism for technical and commercial concerns to be raised without retaliation or domination by title.

8. Draft the staged response. Write the action, owner, timing, communication and review point for stage one and stage two.

9. Stress-test the choice. Consider what happens if the client refuses a delay, if the risk is less severe than thought, or if the CEO insists on release.

10. Gallery review. Compare decisions with another group and identify where a preferred personal style may have replaced situational judgment.

Suggested timing

- 5 minutes - Issue and shared interests

- 8 minutes - Condition ratings
- 8 minutes - Style benefits and risks
- 7 minutes - Non-negotiables and authority
- 7 minutes - Staged response
- 5 minutes - Stress test
- 5 minutes - Gallery review

Discussion questions

- Which part of the issue is non-negotiable, and who has authority to decide it?
- Where would collaboration add value after the immediate decision?
- What power imbalance or voice risk must the facilitator manage?
- What temporary agreement could protect the client relationship without compromising security?

Submission

Submit the completed worksheet and checklist. Use role names rather than real personal data, mark unresolved information as unknown and retain the artefact only through the approved course channel.

Debrief

The recommendation links each style choice to evidence about safety, stakes, relationship, power and time.